rather contextual sequence of sentences, that is the bearer of meaning – that which is understood.

Phonemes in a single word and the individual words themselves are fictions that help grammarians to analyse and discuss language. Individual words are abstractions from sentences. We do not normally use them on their own. (Saying 'yes' or 'no' is a response to a sentence. 'Fire' means 'run for safety'.) Once it is accepted that it is the sentence rather than individual words that is primarily meaningful, it is a short step to the idea that it is the paragraph or chapter or whole text that is the bearer of significance. These larger contexts are themselves understood in the context of the whole of language. So it turns out that meaning is total and undivided: distribution into books, paragraphs, sentences and words are all cases of apparent fragmentation that serves human purposes. This holistic concept of meaning is then identified as the Absolute Reality. Wider contexts, sentences, words and letters can be seen as progressive fragmentary emanations of a semantic absolute in which thought and language are not differentiated prior to the emergence of words.

Further reading: Brough 1996a and 1996b; Matilal 1986 and 1990; Shastri 1959

Svabhava (literally 'own-being'): the essential nature shared by members of a kind of entities. It is understood as entirely self-sufficient and invariant. *Svarupa* ('own-form') usually means the same.

Svabhava-hetu: a form of inference developed by the Buddhist ***Dharmakirti*** in which the logical reason (***hetu***) shares the nature of the property to be proved (***sadhya***) or the ***sadhya*** shares the nature of the ***hetu***. So we can reason that if something is an oak, it is a tree.

Further reading: Kajiyama 1998; Prasad 2002